

June

2

1953

Coronation on TV

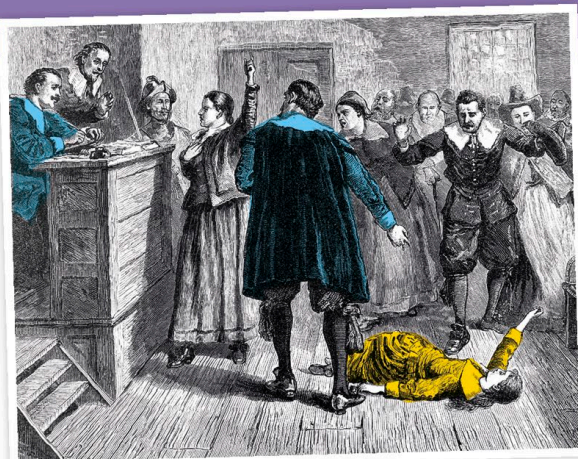
Watched on TV by millions of people worldwide, Elizabeth II was crowned Queen of the United Kingdom, Canada, Australia, New Zealand, and other Commonwealth territories in a ceremony at Westminster Abbey in London, UK.



Combahee River Raid

1863

US anti-slavery activist Harriet Tubman led a group of 150 Black soldiers along South Carolina's Combahee River during the US Civil War, freeing more than 700 enslaved people. She was the first woman to direct a major US military operation.



1692 Witch trials

In Salem, USA, people (mostly women) accused of practising witchcraft began to be convicted. They were sentenced to death by hanging, not burned at the stake as popularly believed.

Also on this day

1924 US president Calvin Coolidge signed the **Indian Citizenship Act**, granting citizenship to all US-born Indigenous people.

1946 In a public vote in Italy, a majority of the citizens voted in favour of changing the country from a monarchy to a republic.

2003 The European Space Agency (ESA) launched its **Mars Express** probe from the Baikonur Cosmodrome in Kazakhstan.

Born this day

1977 Zachary Quinto, US actor and producer. He starred as the villain Silar in the TV series *Heroes* and as Spock in some of the *Star Trek* films.